

BRITTANY ALMQUIST LEWIS

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Olin School of Business, Washington Univ. St. Louis, <i>Assistant Prof. of Finance</i>	2022 – present
Guthrie Center for Real Estate, Northwestern University, <i>Visiting Scholar</i>	2020 – 2025
Kelley School of Business, Indiana University, <i>Visiting Associate Researcher</i>	2022 – 2023
Kelley School of Business, Indiana University, <i>Assistant Prof. of Finance</i>	2020 – 2022

RESEARCH APPOINTMENTS

Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, <i>Dissertation Fellow</i>	Jul. – Nov. 2018
Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco Thomas J. Sargent, <i>Dissertation Fellow</i>	Jun. – Jul. 2018

RESEARCH FIELDS

Financial Intermediation, Household Finance, Real Estate

EDUCATION

Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University, Ph.D. Finance, 2020
Dissertation: “Essays on Financial Intermediation”
Committee: Dimitris Papanikolaou, Lawrence Christiano, Janice Eberly, John Mondragon
Kellogg School of Management, Northwestern University, M.S. Finance, 2020
Boston College, B.A. Finance (cum laude), 2010
Boston College, B.A. Information Systems (cum laude), 2010

PUBLICATIONS

1. Lewis, Brittany, 2023, “[Creditor Rights, Collateral Reuse, and Credit Supply](#),” *Journal of Financial Economics* (2023) 149, 451-472

(previously titled: *The Effect of Dealer Leverage on Mortgage Quality*)

- [Online Appendix](#)
- [Replication Package](#)
- Press: [Harvard Law School Forum on Corporate Governance](#) • [The Olin Blog](#) • [Kelley School of Business News](#)
- AEA 2022: [Poster Presentation](#)

Securities dealers receive mortgages as collateral for credit lines provided to mortgage companies and reuse the same collateral to borrow money. Exploiting the 2005 BAPCPA rule change, which granted mortgage collateral preferred bankruptcy treatment, I find that strengthening creditor rights increases dealers' collateral reuse. Increasing collateral reuse creates a money multiplier that increases credit supply. Using a novel dataset linking dealers to the mortgage companies they fund reveals that post-BAPCPA, dealers supply

additional credit to mortgage companies by increasing credit lines and relaxing restrictions on collateral securing them. In response, mortgage companies increase origination volume and shift into riskier products.

2. Lewis, Brittany, 2025, “[Bank Leverage Restrictions in General Equilibrium: Solving for Sectoral Value Functions](#),” *Journal of Risk and Financial Management - Special Issue: Financial Resilience in Turbulent Times (2025)* 18(9), 519

This paper develops a tractable method to solve a general equilibrium model with bank runs and exogenous leverage ratio restrictions, enabling welfare analysis of macroprudential policy across the business cycle. By computing bankers’ value functions via backward induction from steady state, the framework quantifies how leverage caps affect capital allocation, asset prices, and run probabilities during recovery from crises. Calibrated simulations show that welfare-enhancing policy is time-varying – lenient when households’ marginal utility of consumption is high, restrictive in low-marginal-utility states. The results highlight a trade-off: tighter leverage restrictions improve stability but risk persistent efficiency losses if imposed too harshly after crises.

- Press: [Olin Business](#), [Professors on Point \(PoP\) Video Series](#), [WashU Olin Business Insights](#)

WORKING PAPERS

3. Hamdi, Naser, Jiang, Erica, **Lewis, Brittany**, Padi, Manisha, and Pal, Avantika, 2023, “[The Rise of Nonbanks in Servicing Household Debt](#),” (*Resubmitted 4th Round to Journal of Finance*)

- Winning NBER grant proposal, "Shadow Banks and Financial Distress in Minority Communities: The Debt Servicing Channel," Co-PI with Erica Jiang and Manisha Padi
- Press: The FinReg Blog Sponsored by Duke Financial Economics Center, AEA 2025 Video Series, Olin CFAR Top Cited Paper of 2024

We study the real effects of capital regulation through the reallocation of mortgage servicing rights (MSRs). Using U.S. credit registry data, we show that Basel III’s stricter MSR treatment induced banks to shed riskier MSRs, leading to a market-wide shift toward nonbank servicers—especially in riskier loan segments—and raising foreclosure rates. To interpret these effects, we develop a model of MSR allocation showing that market equilibrium does not necessarily minimize investor–servicer misalignment. Foreclosure gap provides a sufficient statistic for welfare. Applying this approach, we conclude that Basel III improved investor welfare, but at the expense of borrowers.

4. **Lewis, Brittany**, Padi, Manisha, 2025, “[Regulating Secondary Loan Markets: Evidence from Small Business Lending](#)” (*Revise and Resubmit at Journal of Financial Economics*)

Rules governing the structure of securitized loan pools can shift lenders’ relative cost of pooling different loans, reallocating access to capital. Utilizing novel data on government-backed loan securitization, we study the impact of tightening secondary market regulation on loan characteristics, using an instrumented difference-in-differences approach. Reform exposure decreases secondary market sale prices, and results in shorter maturities and lower loan defaults. The reform reallocates capital away from industries needing long-term capital investments, causing real economic effects. Our results suggest that making loans more similar within securitized pools can restrict access to capital for more costly or hard-to-pool loan types.

5. **Lewis, Brittany**, Padi, Manisha, Wang, Xiyu, Wang, Zhongyu 2025, “[The Cost of Servicing Debt Pools](#)”

Mortgage servicers face highly variable costs and depend on servicing fees for compensation. We demonstrate that the majority of servicing fees are uniform across securitized loan pools, consistent with average cost pricing. We calculate a risk based break-even servicing fee for each loan and document significant mispricing, which potentially distorts servicers’ foreclosure incentives. Utilizing quasi-random assignment of loans to pools, we establish that higher mispricing increases borrower foreclosure rates and decreases investor returns, with more severe distortions in heterogeneous pools. A theoretical welfare framework comparing uniform versus variable fee regimes shows that investor losses are small relative to borrower losses.

6. **Lewis, Brittany**, 2022, “[The Impact of Warehouse Collateral Value on Mortgage Originations](#)”

- Winning proposal: IU Racial Justice Research Fund Grant "Racial Inequality in the Housing Market"
- Press: [Wells Fargo Advisors CFAR “See Far” Magazine \(Featured Article\)](#), [WashU Expert](#)
- [March 13, 2026 Executive Order - Critique Requested by Senator Warren's Banking Committee](#)

I study how, when the borrower is a financial intermediary, increasing collateral value — by strengthening creditor rights on collateral backing warehouse funding — spurs downstream lending product innovation, stimulating credit demand, and longer-term effects. Exploiting BAPCPA 2005 causally isolates increased collateral value’s effect on downstream lending innovation. More exposed regions receive increased alternative mortgages with lower documentation and initial-payment-to-balance ratios, crowding out government mortgages and expanding, then contracting, mortgage demand. More exposed regions experience increased payment shocks on resetting mortgages, degraded loan performance, amplified home price cycles, and adverse labor market outcomes — especially among minority borrowers.

7. Dalgic, Husnu, **Lewis, Brittany**, Modena, Andrea, 2026 “**Pledgeable Collateral, Dealer Leverage, and Runs**”

We show that changes to collateral bankruptcy protection in wholesale funding markets have counterintuitive implications for financial stability. We build a model of financial intermediaries that can raise financing by pledging collateral in the sale and repurchase (repo) market. In the short-term, increasing collateral pledgeability makes repo creditors safer and reduces run risk, but in the long-term, it expands debt capacity and leverage, increasing run risk. We show that this result is a feature of short-term debt backed by moderate-volatility assets: when liabilities are long-term or the asset has high volatility, market discipline leads to lower post-policy leverage. Hand-collected data on dealer repo collateral confirms that BAPCPA’s creditor right strengthening increases pledgeability of collateral, which drives an increase in short-term leverage and larger de-leveraging in a downturn, consistent with a bank run.

SEMINARS & CONFERENCES

*Seminars (including scheduled), *presented by co-author, +postponed due to COVID*

2026: CU-Boulder (Leeds) • UCSD (Rady) • BYU • Utah (Eccles) • Ellington Wealth Management • Berkeley-Law* • Federal Reserve Board*

- 2025:** Goethe & SAFE • University Carlos III de Madrid • Junior Household Finance Seminar (UVA, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia) • Michigan (Ross) • Australian National University • Berkeley Law* • University of Toronto (Law)* • ETH Zurich (Law & Econ)* • University of Zurich (Law & Econ)* • NY Fed* • UNC Charlotte*
- 2024:** CFAR Fall Board Meeting • UNSW • University of Sydney • University of Melbourne • Yale Law* • U Chicago Law* • Columbia Law* • Cornell*
- 2023:** CU-Boulder Leeds • UT Austin (McCombs) • Washington University in St. Louis • Federal Reserve Board* • UT-Austin Law* • UT-Dallas Law* • Treasury* • USC – Marshall*
- 2022:** Federal Reserve Bank of New York
- 2021:** Junior Household Finance Seminar (UVA, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia) • University of Oregon (Lundquist) • IU Summer Health Policy Workshop • Stanford GSB • Washington University in St. Louis (Olin)
- 2020:** Emory (Goizueta) • Federal Reserve Bank of New York • University of Georgia (Terry) • University of Delaware (Lerner) • University of Wisconsin-Madison • Federal Reserve Board of Governors • Johns Hopkins (Carey) • Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond • Federal Reserve Bank of Boston • London Business School • Bank for International Settlements • Indiana University (Kelley) • Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas • University of Melbourne+ • Monash University+ • Junior Household Finance Seminar (UVA, Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia) • Northwestern Department of Economics
- 2019:** Wisconsin School of Business at UW Madison • Kellogg School of Management Strategy Department • Northwestern Department of Economics
- 2018:** Federal Reserve Bank of San Francisco • Federal Reserve Board of Governors Division of Financial Stability
- 2008:** Boston College Undergraduate Research Symposium, *Awarded Best Presentation*

*Conference Presentations (including scheduled), *presented by co-author, ^poster*

- 2027:** AEA
- 2026:** WashU Olin Business and University of Gothenburg Joint Conference • ALEA • AREUEA • Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance (EIEF) 8th Rome Junior Finance Conference • ECWFC
- 2025:** AEA^ • SFS Cavalcade • EFA • ALEA*
- 2024:** CEPR Household Finance Conference • UW Fostering Inclusion Workshop • BIS-CEPR-SCG-SFI Conference on Financial Intermediation^ • Philadelphia Fed Mortgage Market Research Conference^ • EFMA • Early Career Women in Finance Conference (ECWFC) • Australian National University Banking and Financial Stability Meeting joint with Financial Research Network FIRN

- 2023:** AFA AFFECT Workshop • Chicago Booth Empirical Finance Conference • SAET • Stanford Institute for Theoretical Economics (SITE) • Red Rock* • INFORMS Annual Meeting • Junior Finance Conference, UW-Madison* • Fischer Shain Research Conference* • Census Bureau Workshop on Race, Ethnicity, and Inequality
- 2022:** AEA • AEA • Berkeley Consumer Law Scholars Conference • WFA • Olin-St. Louis Federal Reserve Mini-Conference
- 2021:** Eastern Economic Association (EEA) • Berkeley Consumer Law Scholars Conference • Midwest Finance Association (MFA) • Oxford Saïd - ETH Zurich Macro-finance Conference

DISCUSSIONS *(including scheduled)*

- 2026:** AFA
- 2025:** MFA
- 2024:** AEA • AFA IBEFA • Berkeley Consumer Law Scholars Conference • Midwest Finance Association (MFA) • BIS-CEPR-SCG-SFI Conference on Financial Intermediation • Western Finance Association (WFA) x2 • EFA
- 2023:** Berkeley Consumer Law Scholars Conference • SFS Cavalcade • NBER Summer Institute (Household Finance) • University of Oregon Summer Finance Conference
- 2022:** Midwest Finance Association (MFA) • Craig Holden Memorial Conference
- 2021:** 5th Annual Yale Junior Finance Conference • Western Economic Association (WEA) • Conference on Financial Economics and Accounting (CFEA)
- 2020:** Midwest Finance Association (MFA)

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Awards:

Eastern Finance Association Rising Scholar	2024
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Fellowships:

AFFECT Grant in support of ECWFC 2025 (\$5,000, Co-PI)	2025
Household Finance Grant, NBER (\$15,000, Co-PI)	2022 – 2023
Research Equipment Fund Grant, Indiana University (\$75,000, PI)	2021
Kelley Research Funding Grant, Kelley School of Business (\$24,500, PI)	2021
Kelley Research Funding Grant, Kelley School of Business (\$15,000, Co-PI)	2021
Racial Justice Research Fund, Indiana University (\$15,000, PI)	2020 – 2021
Kellogg Research Funding Grant, Northwestern University (\$3,000, PI)	2019
Kellogg School of Management Fellowship, Northwestern University	2014 – 2019
MFS - 10th Macro Finance Society Workshop Ph.D. Award (Link)	2017
Henrietta Grigg-Lewis Foundation Scholarship	2006 – 2009
Boston College Advanced Study Grant, Awarded Best Presentation	2007
Western New York Academic Scholarship	2006 – 2007

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Refereeing:

Journal of Finance, Journal of Financial Economics, Journal of Financial Intermediation, Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis, Journal of Financial Services Research, Journal of Monetary Economics, Management Science, Real Estate Economics, Review of Corporate Finance Studies, Review of Financial Studies

Service to the Profession:

2026 22nd Annual Olin Finance Conference at WashU Organizer
 2025 20th Early Career Women in Finance Conference (ECWFC) Organizer
 2025 WFA Program Committee
 2024 WFA Program Committee; Session Chair, co-chair w/ Emily Williams *HBS*
 2023 EFA Session Chair, co-chair w/ Arkodipta Sarkar *NUS*
 2020 SFS Cavalcade North America Faculty Host - First Virtual Conference
 2020 Federal Reserve Board Mentoring to Interns

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Washington University – St. Louis

FIN 4601/5601: Research Methods in Finance (MSFQ, Undergraduate)	Fall 2022 – present
• Previously numbered FIN 470A/560A	
FIN 3150: Capital Markets and Financial Management (Undergraduate)	Fall 2025 – present

Indiana University

F300: Introduction to Financial Management (Undergraduate)	Fall 2020 – Fall 2021
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Northwestern University (teaching assistant)

FINC 470: International Finance (MBA and Executive MBA) Professor Sergio Rebelo	Fall 2015 – Fall 2017
FINC 941: Macroeconomic Policy and Global Capital Markets (MBA) Professor Janice Eberly Professor Nicolas Crouzet	Winter 2016 – Spring 2017

Boston College (teaching assistant)

ISYS0021: Computers in Management (Undergraduate) Professor Gerald Kane	Fall 2007 – Fall 2008
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RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Professor Brian Weller, Kellogg School of Management	Jul. – Aug. 2015
Research Assistant to Professor Gerald C. Kane, Boston College	Mar. 2007 – May 2008

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Analysis Group, Summer Analyst Intern (2008)/Analyst/Sr. Analyst, Boston, MA	Aug. 2010 – Jun. 2014
Pioneer Investments, Equity Research Summer Analyst, Singapore	Aug. – Sep. 2009
KPMG, Information Technology (IT) Advisory Summer Analyst, New York City, NY	Jun. – Jul. 2009

OTHER ACTIVITIES AND SERVICE

Outreach:

Public Service Economics, Boston

2010-2013

Dress for Success – Database Manager, Boston

2008-2009

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: USA

SKILLS

Language: English (native), Spanish (advanced)

Computer: SAS, STATA, R, SQL, Matlab, Fortran, Python, Command Line Scripting, HTML, PHP, LiveCode, Socialtext Wiki, LaTeX

STUDENT PLACEMENTS

PhD Students

Weiting Hu – University of Queensland (2023)

Master's Students

Joey (Zhongyu) Wang – Univ. of Rochester Simon Finance (PhD 2025)

Kara (Jiaye) Wei – Chubb Insurance - Workforce Management Manager (2025)

Snow Feng – Fuyao Glass Corp - Electronic Data Interchange (EDI) Analyst (2025)

Xiaoling Wu – UC Boulder Leeds Finance (PhD 2024)

Kaihong Luo – CUHK (Pre-doc 2023)